

Recollection of the Dharma

Dharmānusmṛti · Toh 280 · Derge Kangyur

ཆསོ་རྩེ་ས་དྭན་པ།

Toh 280 in the Kangyur is a short liturgical text known in Sanskrit as the Dharma-anusmṛti and in Tibetan as Chos rjes su dran pa, meaning "Recollection of the Dharma" in English. It belongs to the traditional series of recollection practices — anusmṛti — in which the practitioner meditates upon and praises the qualities of the Three Jewels, and this particular text is devoted to extolling the virtues of the Dharma as proclaimed by the buddhas. The text describes the sublime Dharma as well proclaimed, wholesome throughout, perfectly pure, and directly knowable by the wise, drawing on formulations found widely across Buddhist tradition. As the opening lines indicate, it follows immediately after the Recollection of the Buddhas in the canonical sequence, situating it within a broader collection of devotional recollection texts in the Kangyur.

abiding on the grounds. These are the great qualities of the Tathāgatas' perfect wisdom. The noble recollection of the buddhas is complete.

In the language of India: Dharma-anusmṛti. In the language of Tibet: Recollection of the Dharma.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The sublime Dharma is well proclaimed; it is the holy life, wholesome at the beginning, wholesome in the middle, wholesome at the end; its meaning is good and its words are good; it is unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and perfectly cleansed. The Dharma and Vinaya proclaimed by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is well proclaimed, perfectly realized, free from illness, uninterrupted in time, inviting one to come and see, meaningful for those who behold it, to be known individually by the wise. The Dharma and Vinaya is well taught; it leads to renunciation, it proceeds to perfect awakening, it is without discord and endowed with harmony, endowed with a sure foundation. It is the path that cuts the stream of continued wandering. The recollection of the Dharma

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens mid-sentence, completing a preceding list of qualities with "abiding on the grounds" before closing the Recollection of the Buddhas section and opening the Recollection of the Dharma. The phrase rendered "inviting one to come and see" translates the

standard technical epithet of the Dharma, ehipaśyika in Sanskrit, here given as འཇོག་པ་ལྟོ་མཐོ་ལྟོ་མཐོ་, meaning something close to "inviting direct inspection." The phrase འཇོག་པ་ལྟོ་མཐོ་ལྟོ་མཐོ་ is slightly ambiguous: it may mean "cutting the stream" of saṃsāric continuity rather than "cutting the path of the stream," and the translation reflects the former, doctrinally standard reading. The text ends mid-sentence, indicating the passage continues beyond the portion provided.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.